



BCG Online Case Assessment

User reference guide & helpful tips

2022



Welcome to BCG!

In preparation for your upcoming Online Case Assessment with BCG, we have created this short document to help you get ready.

Please take the time to read through this document, which explains what you can expect during the Online Case Assessment, and provides some tips and tricks to help you be successful!

Best of luck!



What is BCG's Online Case Assessment?

What can you expect?



Format

100% online, taken from your home on your personal computer; conducted by our chatbot, Casey

Duration

~40 minutes: short introduction video + 35 min to complete the case + 1-min video recording at the end

Assessment Details

Case consists of 8-10 questions + a video recording at the end

Questions can be multiple choice, short answer, or fill-in

At the end, you will be asked to answer a question over video. You will have 1 minute to prepare, and 1 minute to record the video.

Example of the case interface (1 of 3)

 Practice Online Case Experience


19:47

have a stable internet connection as well as a calculator handy as you may have to do some calculations.

This is a **timed section**. If you would like to take a break, please take it now and you can come back when you're ready. **Once you start**, you can take up to **20 minutes** to complete the section.

24 Dec, 10:48 AM

I'm ready!

You have till
24 Dec, 11:08 AM
to complete this section. 20 minutes from now ...

(Question 1 of 5)

Our client is the world's second largest container shipping company by revenues. Last week, two of our competitors announced a merger that would create a joint entity larger than we are. Our client needs to figure out how to respond.

Which of the following approaches would you use to solve this problem?

24 Dec, 10:48 AM

Make a study of our own revenues and costs to decide how we can maximize profit

Determine how we can regain our position as second largest player

Understand how the merger will affect us, then decide on an appropriate course of action

Look for a suitable merger partner as well



Casey will guide you through the test questions, and give you relevant context as needed

Example of the case interface (2 of 3)

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Practice Online Case Experience

13:35

If our competitors increase their market share, they can influence pricing power, leading to a price war. If we have less market share, we are at the losing end of the pricing & market share bargain. Need to figure out how to counter this move.

Thanks. The most important consequence that we are concerned about is

State the 3 cost items that are likeliest to experience a significant percentage decrease due to the merger.

Cost of ship crew	Cost of finance personnel
Interest expense	Marketing spend
Cost of fuel	Taxes
Depreciation	IT costs
Port fees	

None of these

Done

You will be asked some multiple-choice questions; please read the questions carefully

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Practice Online Case Experience

14:54

and you can come back when you're ready. Once you start, you can take up to 20 minutes to complete the section.

25 Dec, 10:29 AM

I'm ready!

You have till 25 Dec, 10:50 AM to complete this section.

Reminder

You have 15 minutes and 0 second left to complete this section.

OK

(Question 1 of 5)

Our client is the revenues. Last w would create a j out how to respo

Which of the following approaches would you use to solve this problem?

A gentle reminder... You have till 25 Dec, 10:50 AM to complete this section which is 15 minutes and 0 second from now ...

25 Dec, 10:35 AM

a study of our own es and costs to decide e can maximize profit

Determine how we can regain our position as second largest player

Understand how the merger will affect us, then decide on an appropriate course of action

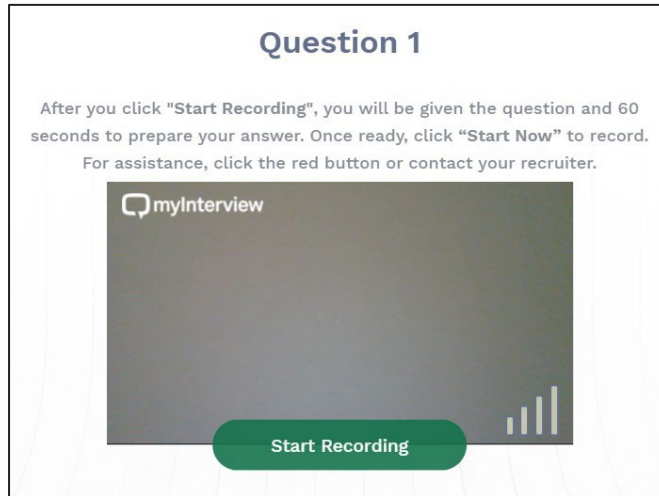
Look for a suitable merg partner as well

Casey will occasionally remind you of remaining time until the end of the test

You can also view the running countdown clock in the top right corner

Example of the case interface (3 of 3)

Start screen

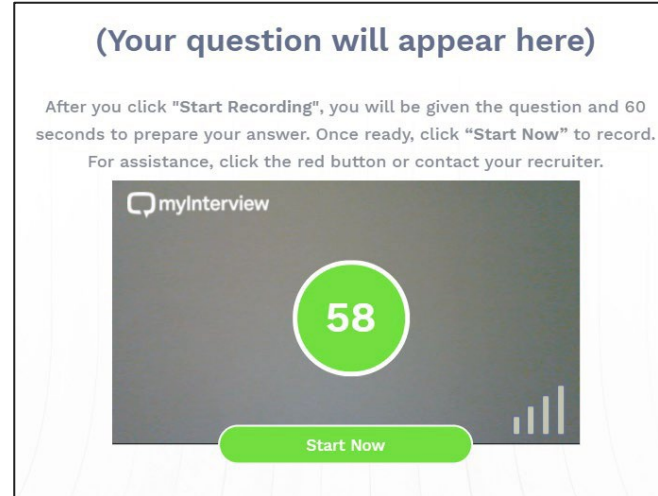


At the end, you will need to record a video of yourself

When prompted, please allow myInterview.com to use your microphone and camera

Click "Start Recording" to begin the process.

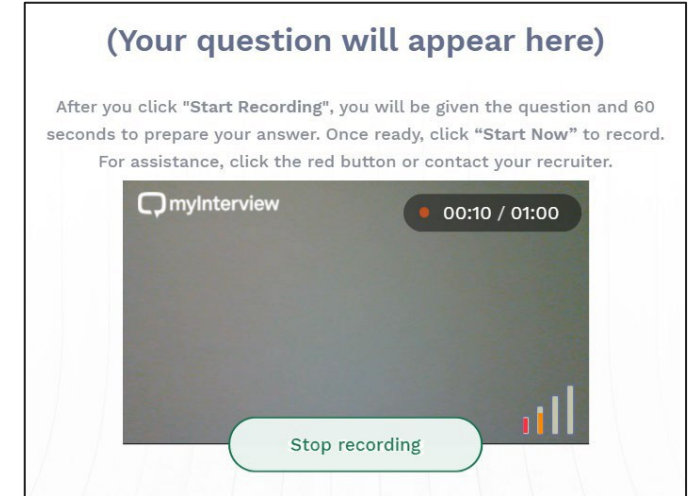
Preparing your answer (60 sec)



After you click "Start Recording", the question will appear. There will be a countdown to let you know how many seconds you have left.

The recording starts automatically after the countdown runs out. If you are ready before that, you can click "Start Now" to immediately begin recording.

Recording your answer (60 sec)



Once recording starts, a timer on the top left will let you know how many seconds you have left to record.



Tips to set you up for success before you take the online case assessment

- We recommend that you complete this [practice case](#) prior to your formal assessment, to familiarize yourself with the format of the test. Please note the practice case is shorter than the real case, as it is meant to get you comfortable with the chatbot and video interview interface.
- You will have **35 mins** to complete the actual assessment. Casey will help you keep track of time, however, please plan accordingly.
- You will not be able to go back and reference exhibits, review, or change previous answers.
- All answer submissions are final. You must work through the case in the order of questions asked. You will not receive your final score.
- You will have only 1 attempt to record your 1-min video at the end of the assessment:
 - You will be given 1 min to prepare your answer, and 1 min to record your delivery via video
- Please refer to the following FAQs for additional technical information

Tips & tricks during the assessment: time management



Practice Online Case Experience



Countdown clock on the right corner helps you to track how much time left

25 Dec, 10:29 AM

I'm ready!

You have till
25 Dec, 10:50 AM
to complete this section. 20 minutes from now ...

(Question 1 of 5)

Our client is the world's second largest container shipping company by revenues. Last week, two of our competitors announced a merger that would create a joint entity larger than we are. Our client needs to figure out how to respond.

Which of the following approaches would you use to solve this problem?

Make a study of our own revenues and costs to decide how we can maximize profit

25 Dec, 10:37 AM

Could you please explain your reasoning in 2-3 lines?

25 Dec, 10:37 AM

test

25 Dec, 10:38 AM

Understanding our revenues and costs is important. Let's think about the impact from our competitors' merger first.

(Question 2 of 5)

Which of the following potential impacts of the merger would be most important to determine, so that we can formulate a suitable response?

A gentle reminder... You have till
25 Dec, 10:50 AM
to complete this section which is 10 minutes and 0 second from now ...

25 Dec, 10:40 AM

Increase in merged entity's
advertising spend

Reduction in our pricing power
and market share

Increase in the range of
destinations offered by the
merged entity

The total market share of the
merged entity

Before every question, you'll see question number and how many questions left

Every 5 minutes you'll have a pop-up reminder on how much time left



Assumed knowledge & glossary of key terms (1/2)

Remember, this is a 'real' case study assessment, you should **prepare for this test as you would a regular case study interview**. That means **some business knowledge** will be required, as well as some analytical problem solving – we strongly recommend that you practice case study interviews before attempting the test. In order to help get you started we have included an initial & non-exhaustive glossary of business terms below, to give you an idea of the kind of language that may be used in the assessment.

- **Fixed costs:** business costs that are not dependent on the amount of goods or services produced by the business, such as rent and management team salaries.
- **Variable costs:** Business costs that change proportionately to the amount of goods and services produced by a business – for example, raw material costs. Variable cost per unit equals total variable costs divided by units sold.
- **Complementary goods:** products which tend to be consumed together (e.g., an iPhone and mobile applications). Thus, increasing demand for one tends to increase demand for the other.
- **Substitute goods:** products which can be used for the same or similar purposes and therefore substitute one another (e.g., skim milk and semi-skim milk)
- **Expected profit:** The profit that a business expects to make, weighted by the probability of all potential profit outcomes. For example, if there is a 60% chance that a business will make \$100,000 on a deal, and 40% chance that it will lose \$50,000, then the expected profit on the deal is $60\% \times \$100,000 + 40\% \times (-\$50,000) = \$40,000$.
- **Stand-alone value:** The value of a company in a merger or acquisition, before taking into account the value of any synergies between the acquiring company and the target company.
- **M&A Synergies:** The potential financial benefit of combining two companies in a merger or acquisition. These may include revenue synergies such as the potential to cross-sell each others' products, thus increasing sales overall. They may also include cost synergies such as the potential to streamline duplicated management and administrative functions.

Assumed knowledge & glossary of key terms (2/2)

It is also important to be familiar with the key elements of a company's income statement, as they are necessary to understand a company's profitability. **Do read through the below definitions in detail** as they are often used in the Online Case Experience.

Revenue

Also known as **sales**, this is the total amount of money received by a business for providing goods and services. For example, for a car manufacturer, this would be the number of cars sold multiplied by average price per car.

Cost of Goods Sold (COGS)/Cost of Sales

The direct costs involved in producing a product or providing a service - for example, the cost of raw materials and factory labor needed to produce a car. Unless otherwise stated in the question, these are assumed to be **variable costs**.

Gross Profit

Revenue less Cost of Goods Sold (variable costs).

Operating Expenses

Costs incurred by a business that are not directly linked to production of a company's goods and services. For a car manufacturer, these could include marketing costs, salaries for non-factory employees, and rental of office space. Unless otherwise stated in the question, these are assumed to be **fixed costs**.

Operating Profit/ Operating Income

Gross Profit less Operating Expenses (fixed costs). Unless otherwise stated, **profit** in the Online Case Experience refers to Operating Profit.

Net Profit/ Net Income

Operating Profit less non-operating expenses such as Interest and Tax. This concept is less often used in the Online Case Experience and will be further explained in the question if necessary.

Frequently Asked Questions (1 of 3)

How do I access the test?

In an invitation email you receive from BCG team there will be a link to the assessment. Please make sure you access the link during the time indicated in your invitation email, otherwise it won't be available.

If you cannot open the link, please contact your recruiter.

What hardware and other technical requirements are needed to complete this test?

A webcam-enabled laptop and a calculator are both required for this test. Do not access the test on a mobile phone.

Please use Chrome, Firefox, or Opera as the web browser. Do not use Internet Explorer. Google Chrome is the preferred browser for this test. Please disable VPN.

For best results, please use an incognito browser window.

Please ensure that you have a stable internet connection while taking the test, especially because you will need to record a video of yourself and the end.

Frequently Asked Questions (2 of 3)

Do I have to complete the test in one sitting?

Yes, you need to complete the test in one sitting, as the timer will continue to run even if you are logged out.

If you are interrupted, you can log back in using the same invitation email and password. You will be brought back to the same place where you left off, but time will have elapsed.

I can't see all of the question content in my test browser – what should I do?

You may find it useful to zoom out on your browser in order to fit all the text in one screen. (For instructions on how to do this in Chrome, [click here](#))

How do I troubleshoot if my webcam isn't properly connected to the technical platform for the video portion of the exam?

Your webcam should automatically connect to the platform. However, in the unlikely event that this occurs, please ensure that other applications that may access or interfere with your webcam (such as other videoconferencing apps) are switched off. If your browser continues to experience issues accessing your webcam, try rebooting, changing to another approved browser (Chrome, Firefox, Opera), or to another computer.

Do note that if the internet connection is slightly unstable, the video service may take up to 30 seconds to connect and initiate. If you continue to experience issues, please try again with another Internet connection.

Frequently Asked Questions (3 of 3)

What if a testing session is interrupted because of poor internet connection or accidental closure of the chat bot?

Click “Refresh” on your browser. You will not lose the progress that you have made and will be able to get back to the same question through the invitation link within 30 mins after the moment when your test began. All answers will be recorded in the platform. Delays can be minimized by ensuring that you have a stable internet connection.

My exhibits won't load / open in one of the questions – what do I do?

Please refresh the page if you face delays in loading either the exhibit or the bot (click on the refresh button on the browser, or highlight the weblink and press enter).

What do I do if I am unable to record the video portion?

While unlikely this will happen, we will still have your quantitative/general test results. We suggest you self-record your answer to the video recommendation prompt using your mobile phone or other device and send this recording to your recruiter.

Will I know my score at the end of the interview?

No. Similar to a live or face-to-face case interview, you will not know how you scored in the Online Case Assessment. Note that scoring varies by question type, and each question may carry a different weight.

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